

HOST WITHOUT THE STRESS

Halloween Party Planner & Games

A complete host kit, plus 4 ready-to-play
games

Everything from the guest list to the games —
so you can actually enjoy your own party.

FORM & FERN

Party Planning Timeline

Spread the work out so the week of the party is calm, not chaotic.

- ☐ 3-4 weeks out: pick a date, theme, and rough guest count
- ☐ 3 weeks out: send invitations, digital or printed
- ☐ 2 weeks out: order or buy any costumes, decor, or rentals needed
- ☐ 1 week out: confirm RSVPs and plan the final menu
- ☐ 1 week out: buy non-perishable decor and game supplies
- ☐ 2-3 days out: buy perishable food and drinks
- ☐ 1 day out: decorate what can be set up early
- ☐ Day of: finish food prep, set out games, and light the candles
- ☐ Day of: take five minutes before guests arrive to just breathe

Guest List & Invitations

Keep track of who's coming so you can plan food, seating, and games accordingly.

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- ☐ Finalized the guest list and any plus-ones
 - ☐ Decided: kids invited, adults-only, or a mixed party
 - ☐ Sent invitations with date, time, address, and costume expectations
 - ☐ Noted any dietary restrictions or allergies mentioned in RSVPs
 - ☐ Tracked RSVPs as they come in
 - ☐ Sent a reminder a few days before the party
 - ☐ Decided on a parking or arrival plan for guests
 - ☐ Planned for a few walk-ins or last-minute yeses
 - ☐ Shared your address or location pin with out-of-town guests
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Decor & Ambiance Checklist

A few well-placed touches go further than covering every surface.

- ☐ Entryway: a wreath, lanterns, or a pumpkin display to set the mood
- ☐ Lighting: string lights, candles, or colored bulbs for ambiance
- ☐ A designated photo spot with a backdrop or fun prop
- ☐ Music playlist queued up ahead of time
- ☐ Tableware and napkins that match your theme or colors
- ☐ A few fog, spooky sound, or scent touches if you want extra atmosphere
- ☐ Outdoor decor visible from the street if you want walk-up appeal
- ☐ A clearly marked spot for coats, bags, or trick-or-treat buckets
- ☐ A test walk-through the space once decor is up, checking for trip hazards

Costume Planning

Whether you're dressing up too or just prepping for guests, plan this early.

- ☐ Decided if the party has a group theme or costumes are open
- ☐ Picked or confirmed your own costume with enough lead time
- ☐ Checked costume comfort for a full evening of standing/sitting
- ☐ Planned makeup or accessories that need extra prep time
- ☐ Set aside a space for guests to touch up costumes or makeup
- ☐ Considered a few spare accessories (masks, hats) for under-dressed guests
- ☐ Planned a costume contest if you want one — see the judging sheet
- ☐ Took a "before" photo of your look before the party starts
- ☐ Packed a small kit for costume repairs (safety pins, tape)

Menu & Treats Planning

Keep the menu simple and mostly make-ahead so you're not stuck in the kitchen all night.

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- ☐ Picked 2-3 savory items that can be made ahead or served cold
 - ☐ Picked 1-2 themed treats or desserts
 - ☐ Planned a drink station, spiked and non-alcoholic options if mixed ages
 - ☐ Noted any allergies or dietary needs from your guest list
 - ☐ Labeled dishes with allergens if serving a larger group
 - ☐ Planned candy or treats specifically for any trick-or-treaters
 - ☐ Assigned a few dishes to guests if doing a potluck-style party
 - ☐ Confirmed you have enough serving dishes, napkins, and utensils
 - ☐ Planned easy reheating or serving instructions for the day of
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Trick-or-Treat Safety Checklist

If your party overlaps with trick-or-treating, a few basics keep it smooth.

- ☐ Left a porch light on (or off, per your household's preference) to signal availability
- ☐ Kept a clear, well-lit, trip-free path to your door
- ☐ Stocked enough candy for your neighborhood's typical turnout
- ☐ Set out a note or sign for allergy-friendly treats if offering any
- ☐ Assigned someone to answer the door if you're mid-party
- ☐ Kept pets in a separate room if door traffic might stress them out
- ☐ Reminded costumed kids in your own group about road safety
- ☐ Kept a flashlight or glow item by the door for after-dark walks
- ☐ Planned a cutoff time for answering the door if needed

Game 1: Spooky Scavenger Hunt

Hide or place these around your party space before guests arrive. First to find all items wins.

- ☐ A plastic spider or bug hidden somewhere unexpected
- ☐ A black cat decoration tucked on a shelf
- ☐ A miniature pumpkin hidden behind something
- ☐ A "witch's hat" object placed somewhere silly
- ☐ A skeleton or bone-shaped item in plain sight but easy to miss
- ☐ A candy corn or orange-and-black item near the food table
- ☐ A spooky word written somewhere in chalk or on a sticky note
- ☐ A bat silhouette taped somewhere on a wall or window
- ☐ One "golden ticket" item that wins an extra prize

Game 2: Halloween Trivia

Read these aloud one at a time — first correct answer gets a point. Answers included below each question.

- ☐ What holiday is traditionally celebrated on October 31st? (Answer: Halloween)
- ☐ What vegetable is traditionally carved into a jack-o'-lantern today? (Answer: Pumpkin)
- ☐ What do you traditionally say when trick-or-treating at a door? (Answer: Trick or treat)
- ☐ What flying nocturnal animal is a classic Halloween symbol? (Answer: Bat)
- ☐ What color combination is most associated with Halloween? (Answer: Orange and black)
- ☐ What sweet, striped candy is a classic Halloween treat? (Answer: Candy corn)
- ☐ What do you call a witch's flying broomstick companion? (Answer: A black cat, traditionally)
- ☐ What was the original vegetable used for jack-o'-lanterns before pumpkins? (Answer: Turnips)

Game 3: Pumpkin Carving Judging Sheet

Have each carver number their pumpkin, then score each category 1-5 as guests vote.

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- ☐ Creativity: how original or unexpected is the design?
 - ☐ Difficulty: how much detail or skill does the carving show?
 - ☐ Spookiness: how well does it fit a classic Halloween mood?
 - ☐ Humor: does it make people laugh or smile?
 - ☐ Overall craftsmanship: clean cuts, stable structure
 - ☐ Tally each pumpkin's total score across all categories
 - ☐ Announce 1st, 2nd, and 3rd place, or just an overall winner
 - ☐ Have a small prize ready for the winner ahead of time
 - ☐ Take a group photo of all the finished pumpkins together

Game 4: Mummy Wrap Relay

A classic team game — no advance prep beyond toilet paper or gauze rolls.

- ☐ Split guests into teams of 2-3 people
- ☐ Give each team one roll of toilet paper or cheap gauze
- ☐ One team member is the "mummy," the others are the wrappers
- ☐ Set a timer — 2-3 minutes works well for most groups
- ☐ Teams race to fully wrap their mummy before time runs out
- ☐ Judge on full coverage, not just speed, if it's close
- ☐ Award a prize for best-wrapped mummy, not just fastest
- ☐ Take photos of the finished mummies for the party memory book
- ☐ Have a backup roll ready in case one team runs out early

Party Day Timeline

A sample run of show — adjust the times to fit your own party's length.

- ☐ 1 hour before: final food prep and decor touch-ups
- ☐ 30 minutes before: music on, lights set, games laid out
- ☐ Arrival: greet guests, take coats, offer a drink
- ☐ First 30-45 minutes: mingling, food, and photos
- ☐ Mid-party: run Game 1 (Scavenger Hunt) once most guests have arrived
- ☐ Mid-party: run Game 2 (Trivia) as a group activity
- ☐ Later: pumpkin carving contest if included, then judging
- ☐ Late-party: Mummy Wrap Relay for a high-energy close
- ☐ Wind-down: dessert, final photos, and thank-yous as guests leave

Cleanup & Thank-You Checklist

A quick plan for the next morning makes cleanup much less overwhelming.

- ☐ Bagged and disposed of easy trash before going to bed
- ☐ Put away food that can be saved for leftovers
- ☐ Recruited a helper or two for the bigger cleanup tasks
- ☐ Took down decor that won't be reused, saved what will
- ☐ Washed or returned any borrowed serving dishes
- ☐ Sent a quick thank-you message to guests who came
- ☐ Shared party photos with the group if you took any
- ☐ Noted what worked well for next year's party
- ☐ Gave yourself credit for hosting — it's genuinely a lot of work